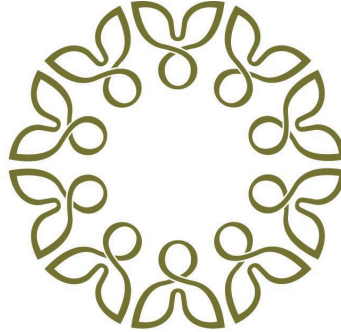




HOLY CROSS FAMILY MINISTRIES

Brand Guidelines

A Practical Guide for International Ministries

This document explains how to use some of the HCFM brand elements correctly.
Following these guidelines ensures consistency across all ministries worldwide.

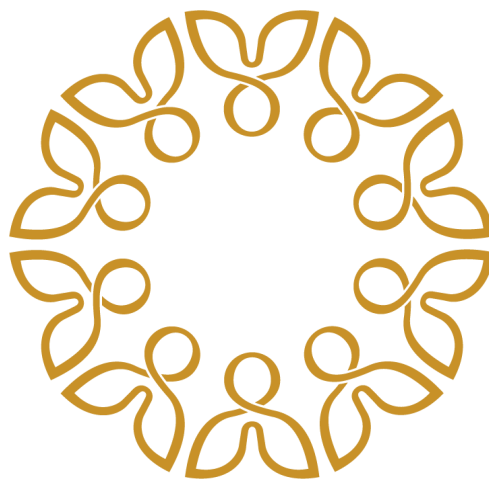
1. Why Brand Consistency Matters

When all HCFM ministries use the same colors, fonts, and visual elements, people recognize us instantly. This recognition builds trust and strengthens our mission. Inconsistent branding confuses our audience and weakens our identity.

This guide gives you clear guidelines to follow. When you follow them, your designs will look professional and unified with the rest of HCFM, no design training required.

2. Our Symbol: A Deeper Meaning

Before learning how to use our visual identity, it's important to understand what it represents. The HCFM symbol is intentionally designed to have a depth of substance—its meaning is not exhausted at first glance.



The Symbol's Multifaceted Meaning

The 10 Beads of the Rosary:

The design is focused on the unit of 10 beads of the Rosary, representing "totality" and "unity", bringing the great variety of family members together in prayer.

A Family of Prayer

The symbol grows out of this set of 10 beads, linked together as a family of prayer. Each bead symbolizes a family member in the position or "gesture" of prayer, each individual member contributing to the whole.

Floral Character: Connection to Mary

The symbol is also designed to express a floral character, calling to mind the Rose, Lily, and Iris—flowers that are symbolic of the Virgin Mary. This reference suggests purity, growth, and peace.

The Moon and Light

The center white space of the symbol is drawn such that it creates an optical phenomenon that seems to emit light. This refers to the symbolism of the "moon" and, combined with the color blue or gold, creates a strong visual connection to Mary.

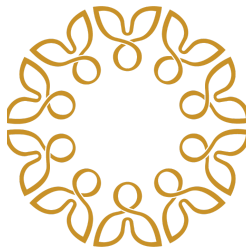
Welcome and Invitation

By design, the symbol radiates and reaches outward, giving a sense of welcome and invitation. The careful delineation of form and space also suggests the sense of mystery that is associated with the work of the Holy Spirit.

Each time the visual identity is seen, one can find and appreciate new meaning in it, while at the same time it is distinctly recognizable and visually strong.

3. Mark vs. Logo: Understanding the Difference

This is one of the most common points of confusion. Here is the simple distinction:

THE MARK	THE LOGO SAMPLE
	
The symbol alone	The symbol + "Holy Cross Family Ministries"
<i>Use when space is limited or when the audience already knows who we are</i>	<i>Use when introducing HCFM or when full identification is needed</i>

When to Use Each

Use the MARK when:

- The design space is small (social media profile pictures, favicons)
- The audience already knows HCFM (internal documents, repeat communications)
- You need a subtle brand presence (watermarks, decorative elements)

Use the LOGO when:

- Introducing HCFM to new audiences
- Creating official documents, letterheads, or certificates
- There is enough space to show it clearly
- The context requires formal brand identification

Available Color Versions

Both the mark and logo come in these approved color versions:

- **Black** — for standard use on light backgrounds
- **HCFM Blue (Pantone 2728C)** — for brand emphasis
- **Gold (Pantone 871C)** — for premium or formal applications
- **Two-tone (Gold symbol + Blue text)** — logo only
- **White/Reversed** — for dark backgrounds

3. Color System

Our color palette creates visual unity across all HCFM communications. Colors are divided into primary colors (used most often) and accent colors (used sparingly for emphasis).

Primary Colors

These are your main colors. Use them for most design work.

BLACK	HEX: #000000 RGB: 0, 0, 0	Use mainly as background for text, overlays on images, and when you need maximum contrast and readability.
HCFM BLUE	HEX: #0047BB RGB: 0, 71, 187	Our signature brand color. Use for headlines, buttons, and key brand moments.
YELLOW GOLD	HEX: #FFB500 RGB: 255, 181, 0	Use for elegant, traditional moments. Borders, decorative elements. And backgrounds in some cases, if necessary.

Accent Colors

Use these sparingly to add visual interest. They should support, not dominate.

LIGHT BLUE	HEX: #00A9E0 RGB: 0, 169, 224	Pairs with Playlist Script font. Use for fresh, modern accents.
MUTED GOLD	HEX: #89764B RGB: 137, 118, 75	Use for elegant, traditional moments. Borders, decorative elements.
WHITE	HEX: #FFFFFF RGB: 255, 255, 255	Use for text on dark backgrounds and for clean space.

Color Best Practices

DO:

- Use black or white for most body text, it's always readable
- Use accent colors sparingly, one accent color per design is usually enough
- Use black transparent overlays on photos to ensure text readability
- Use color fades and accents only within our brand palette

DON'T:

- Don't use colors outside this palette
- Don't use Yellow Gold and for large areas of text, it's hard to read
- Don't mix all accent colors in one design, pick one or two.
- Don't place light text on light backgrounds without sufficient contrast

4. Typography (Fonts)

Consistent font usage creates a professional, unified look. Here are the approved fonts and how to use them.

Primary Fonts

Use these for most text in your designs.

Calluna	A serif font. Use for body text, longer paragraphs, and formal documents. Elegant and easy to read.
Whitney	A sans-serif font. Use for headlines, subheadings, and short text. Clean and modern.

Secondary Font: Playlist Script

This decorative script font adds elegance but requires careful use.

WHEN TO USE - To emphasize a single word or short phrase - For stylistic, decorative moments - When you want to add warmth or elegance	WHEN NOT TO USE - For full sentences or paragraphs - For body text or long content - At small sizes (it becomes unreadable)
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Playlist Script Color Guidelines

Playlist Script is preferably used in these three colors:

Yellow Gold #FFB500	White #FFFFFF	Light Blue #00A9E0
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Only use Playlist Script within our color palette.

Font Best Practices and Recommended combinations

- Whitney (headline) + Calluna (body)
- Whitney (headline) + Playlist Script (emphasis word) + Calluna (body)

5. Design Elements

These are the approved stylistic elements that give HCFM designs their distinctive look. Use them thoughtfully, less is more.

Approved Elements

Thin Border	Use colors within the brand color palette. Use to frame content or add elegance. Keep it thin (3-4 pixels) maximum.
Color Fade Effect	Gradients using only colors within our brand palette. Never introduce outside colors into fades.
Curved Shapes	Soft, rounded shapes that create visual interest. Reflect the organic forms in our mark.
Dark Overlays	Black transparent overlays on photos. Essential for making text readable over images. Typically 40-60% opacity.

How to Use Design Elements

The rule: Use only a few elements per design. Combining too many creates visual clutter.

Good example:

- A social post with a photo, dark overlay for readability, and a thin gold border

Too much:

- A design with color fades, curved shapes, gold border, multiple font styles, AND animation

Visual Effects:

Visual effects should be handled sparingly and respectfully. Excessive animation or "over-the-top" treatments will damage brand recognition and diminish the reputation of Holy Cross Family Ministries.

When in doubt, keep it simple. A clean, clear design is always better than a busy one.

6. Imagery Direction

The images we use tell our story. Choose imagery that reflects our mission and values.

Approved Image Categories

- **Father Patrick Peyton:** our founder and spiritual guide
- **Ministry center / culture-specific imagery:** reflecting our global reach
- **Marian imagery:** honoring our devotion to Mary
- **Family prayer:** families praying together
- **Rosary imagery:** the rosary as our central prayer

Image Best Practices

- Use high-quality images only
- When applicable, apply dark overlays when placing text over images

7. Platform Content Dimensions

PLATFORM	CONTENT TYPE	DIMENSIONS (px)
Instagram	Static Image (Portrait)	1080 x 1350
	Reel / Story	1080 x 1920
Facebook	Static Image (Portrait)	1080 x 1350
	Video (Feed)	1280 x 720
	Reels	1080 x 1920
LinkedIn	Static Image	1200 x 627
	Portrait Image	1080 x 1350
X (Twitter)	Static Image	1200 x 675
YouTube	Thumbnail	1280 x 720

8. Quick Reference Checklist

Before you finalize any design, run through this checklist:

Colors

- Am I using only HCFM brand colors?
- Is my text readable against the background?
- Am I using accent colors sparingly (not as main colors)?

Fonts

- Am I using only approved fonts (Calluna, Whitney, Playlist Script)?
- Is Playlist Script used only for short phrases?

Design Elements

- Am I using only a few design elements (not all at once)?
- Is the design clean and not cluttered?
- Are visual effects minimal

Platform

- Am I using the correct dimensions for this platform?
- Have I checked how it will look on mobile?

When in doubt, keep it simple. A clean, consistent design always wins.

Questions? Contact the HCFM Marketing Team.